

ALGERIA

PRE-TOURNAMENT ANALYSIS • WORLD CUP 2026

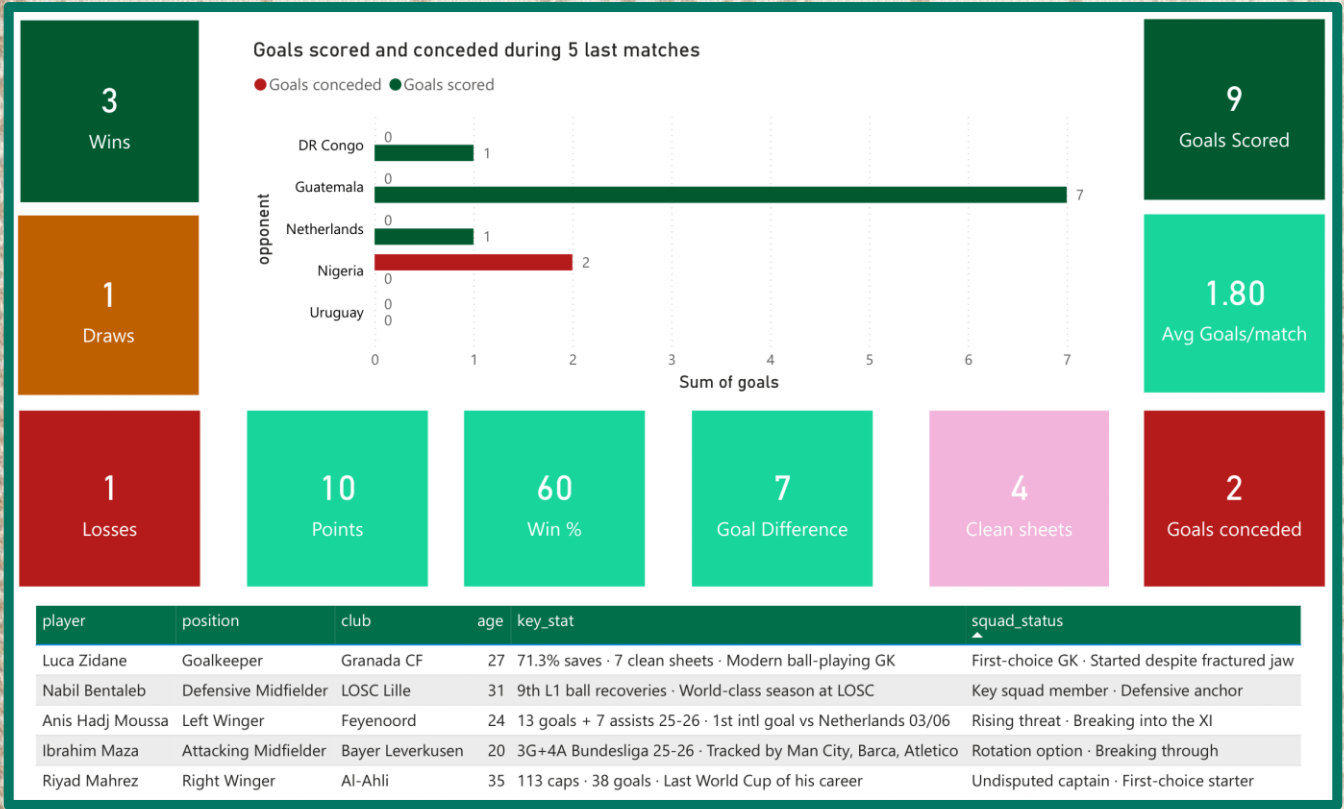
GROUP D

ARGENTINA • AUSTRIA • JORDAN



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ARGENTINA

17/06 • LAST WORLD CUP CHAMPIONS

FIFA

#3

AUSTRIA

28/06 • DIFFICULT

FIFA

#25

JORDAN

23/06 • MANAGEABLE

FIFA

#87

GOAL: 2ND PLACE - ARGENTINA DIFFICULT TO BEAT • JORDAN MANAGEABLE •
AUSTRIA = KEY MATCH



1-0
PAYS-BAS



0-0
URUGUAY



7-0
GUATEMALA



0-2
NIGERIA



1-0
DR CONGO

OPPONENT	COMPETITION	POSS.	SHOTS	EXPECTED GOALS
PAYS-BAS	FRIENDLY	48%	8	ND
URUGUAY	FRIENDLY	41%	6	0.45
GUATEMALA	FRIENDLY	62%	29	ND
NIGERIA	CAN QF	30%	3	0.13
DR CONGO	CAN 1/8	57%	12	0.70



7 GOALS VS GUATEMALA (FIFA #140+) INFLATE STATS - EXCL. OUTLIER: 2 GOALS IN 4 SERIOUS MATCHES

STRENGTHS

4 CLEAN SHEETS IN 5 MATCHES

EFFECTIVE LOW BLOCK VS TOP SIDES (1-0 VS NED)

QUICK COUNTER-ATTACK

DEFENSIVE STRENGTH WITH STABILITY AND GREAT GOALKEEPER

HG 0.70 VS DRC • 1.90 VS EQ. GUINEA

WEAKNESSES

H.GOALS 0.13 VS NIGERIA - KNOCKED OUT

30% POSSESSION UNDER PRESSURE

LIMITED OPTIONS VS LOW BLOCK

OVER-RELIANCE ON AMOURA / MAHREZ

0 SHOTS ON TARGET VS URUGUAY

FORMATIONS USED:

4-2-3-1 (NGA)

5-2-2-1 (URU)

4-4-2 (GUA)

4-3-3 (RDC)

4-5-1 (PE)

PETKOVIC → 4-3-3 LOW PIVOT OR 3-MAN BACKLINE WITHOUT WINGERS ?

STRENGTH / WEAKNESS DEPENDING ON SYSTEM VS ARGENTINA / AUSTRIA



R. MAHREZ

AL-AHLI • 35

113 CAPS • 38 GOALS
UNDISPUTED CAPTAIN
LAST WORLD CUP OF HIS
CAREER



N. BENTALEB

LOSC • 31

5TH LIGUE 1 BALL RECOVERIES
LOSC METRONOME
RETURN AFTER CARDIAC
ARREST



L. ZIDANE

GRANADA • 27

71.3% SAVES • 7 CS
MODERN BALL-PLAYING GK
END OF ALGERIA'S GK
PROBLEM ?

EVEN IF HADJ-MOUSSA IS PUSHING STRONGLY, RIYAD MAHREZ IS STILL COMPETITIVE AT 35Y, HIS EXPERIENCE AND TECHNICAL QUALITY VS BIG TEAMS ARE IMPORTANT TO KEEP THE BALL.

BENTALEB DID A WORLD-CLASS SEASON IN LILLE, HIS A MIDFIELD BOSS AND HIS EXPERIENCE CROSSED WITH HIS TECHNIQUE, VISTA AND PASSING SKILLS ARE USEFUL FOR ALGERIA, HE SHOWED VS NETHERLANDS.

ZIDANE IS THE KEY ALGERIA NEEDED, STRONG GK WITH AMAZING FOOTWORK SKILLS, SHORT AND LONG PASSES

ONE TO WATCH



ANIS HADJ MOUSSA

FEYENOORD • 24

13 GOALS + 7 ASSISTS 25-26

1ST INTL GOAL VS NETHERLANDS 03/06

DESIGNATED MAHREZ SUCCESSOR

NOT YET UNDISPUTED STARTER BUT RISING

ONE TO WATCH



IBRAHIM MAZA

LEVERKUSEN • 20

36+48 BUNDESLIGA 25-26

TRACKED BY MAN CITY, BARCA, ATLETICO

FUTURE WORLD-CLASS TALENT

YOUNGEST OF HIS GENERATION

PROBABLY THE NEXT TWO LEADERS AND STARS OF ALGERIA. BOTH DID AN AMAZING SEASON IN THEIR CLUBS AND ARE TARGETED BY EUROPEAN GIANTS, BUT EVEN IF FANS AND ALGERIAN PEOPLES ARE PUSHING, THE COACH PREFER TO PUT MORE EXPERIENCED PLAYERS OF THE FIELD. HOWEVER, THEIR ROLE WITHIN THE SQUAD CAN CHANGE DURING THIS WC AND EVEN AS SUPERSUB THEY CAN CHANGE THE ISSUE OF THE GAME.



THIS IS PROBABLY THE SQUAD WE ARE GOING TO SEE VS AUSTRIA AND JORDAN, VS ARGENTINA PETKOVIC WILL MAYBE CHOOSE 5 DEFENDERS OPTION. SOLID DEFENSE, MANY OPTIONS IN THE MIDFIELD DEPENDING ON WAY OF PLAYING WITH BOX-TO-BOX PLAYERS AND BIG TECHNICAL QUALITIES. MAHREZ TOUCH WITH GOUIRI'S INTELLIGENCE AND AMOURA'S SPEED COULD BE VERY DIFFICULT TO DEFEND FOR OPPONENTS, ESPECIALLY WHEN WE KNOW WHAT'S ON THE BENCH...



THIS IS A POSSIBLE OPTION TO HAVE MORE DENSITY IN THE CENTER AGAINST BIG TEAMS LIKE ARGENTINA OR SPAIN/URUGUAY IF ALGERIA QUALIFY FOR ROUND OF 32. VERY INTERESTING WITH MAZA AND CHAÏBI THAT CAN RECOVER BALLS OR LOOK FORWARD QUICKLY. WINGERS COULD BE THE VICTIMS OF SUCH A SYSTEM..



COLLECTIVE STRENGTHS

TACTICAL FLEXIBILITY - ADAPTS SYSTEM MATCH BY MATCH. MIDFIELD CONTROL THROUGH BENTALEB. DANGEROUS WIDE AREAS VIA AIT-NOURI + MAHREZ/HADJ MOUSSA. PROVEN IN BIG-GAME MANAGEMENT.

COLLECTIVE WEAKNESSES

HIGH DEFENSIVE LINE EXPOSED TO COUNTER-ATTACKS. INDIVIDUAL ERRORS WHEN PUSHING FORWARD. PSYCHOLOGICAL PRESSURE OF EXPECTATIONS HISTORICALLY A BURDEN FOR THIS SQUAD.

PETKOVIC'S STYLE

FLEXIBLE TACTICIAN - USES 3-4-3, 5-4-1 OR 4-1-4-1 DEPENDING ON THE OPPONENT. KNOWN FOR HIGH-PRESS ATTACKING FOOTBALL WITH FULL TEAM INVOLVEMENT DEFENSIVELY. WON THE COPPA ITALIA WITH LAZIO IN 2013, ELIMINATED FRANCE AT EURO 2020 WITH SWITZERLAND. WITH ALGERIA: SHIFTED THE TEAM TOWARD DISCIPLINED BALL CONTROL AND FAST TRANSITIONS. PREFERS CONSISTENCY OVER EXPERIMENTATION IN TOURNAMENTS.

VS ARGENTINA (FIFA #3)

17/06

HYBRID 4-3-3 SHIFTING TO 4-2-3-1. MESSI IN A PROTECTED FREE ROLE, DE PAUL AS HIS BODYGUARD ON THE RIGHT. ONLY 10 GOALS CONCEDED IN 18 QUALIFYING GAMES. WEAKNESS: AGEING MIDFIELD EXPOSED BY HIGH PRESS. ALGERIA'S KEY: TARGET THE RIGHT CHANNEL ON TRANSITION AND LIMIT MESSI'S TOUCHES IN DANGEROUS ZONES

VS JORDAN (FIFA #87)

23/06

3-4-3 BECOMING 5-4-1 OUT OF POSSESSION. 40% AVERAGE POSSESSION IN QUALIFYING - BUILT TO DEFEND AND COUNTER. 32 GOALS SCORED ON DIRECT ATTACKS, ONLY 4 CONCEDED. WEAKNESS: POOR DECISION-MAKING AND LOW CONVERSION RATE IN THE FINAL THIRD. ALGERIA'S KEY: BREAK THE LOW BLOCK EARLY

VS AUSTRIA (FIFA #25)

28/06

4-2-3-1 GEGENPRESSING UNDER RANGNICK, FATHER OF HIGH-PRESS FOOTBALL. TOPPED EURO 2024 GROUP AHEAD OF FRANCE AND NETHERLANDS. 22 GOALS, 4 CONCEDED IN QUALIFYING. WEAKNESS: OVER-RELIANCE ON 36-YEAR-OLD ARNUTOVIC, PRESSING SYSTEM TIRES IN LONG TOURNAMENTS. ALGERIA'S KEY: USE WIDE AREAS TO BYPASS CENTRAL OVERLOAD, PROTECT HALF-SPACES.



PRE-WORLD CUP VERDICT

REALISTIC GOAL

LOGIC SAYS GROUP D OFFERS A CLEAR PATH: HOLD ARGENTINA, BEAT JORDAN, WIN THE AUSTRIA DECIDER. ROUND OF 32 IS THE MINIMUM OBJECTIVE. BUT IF ALGERIA QUALIFY - SPAIN OR URUGUAY AWAIT. TWO TEAMS BEATABLE ON A GREAT DAY. PETKOVIC BEAT FRANCE AT EURO 2020. THIS SQUAD HAS THE DEFENSIVE STRUCTURE AND INDIVIDUAL QUALITY TO DREAM. ONE BIG NIGHT COULD CHANGE EVERYTHING.

FOOTBALL WITHOUT DATA IS JUST OPINION. HERE'S WHAT THE NUMBERS SAY ABOUT ALGERIA BEFORE THEIR BIGGEST CHALLENGE IN YEARS - GROUP D, WORLD CUP 2026



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